

THREADCAST

A Tabletop Roleplaying Game Set in the World of Aethros

What You Need to Play

This document • Polyhedral dice (d4, d6, d8, d10, d12, d20) • A Character Sheet • Pencils & tokens • 3+ players and one Weavekeeper (GM)

PART ONE: INTRODUCTION

What Is THREADCAST?

THREADCAST is a tabletop roleplaying game of leyline magic, political ambition, and the cost of power. You play mages, soldiers, scholars, and survivors in Aethros — a world where every person is born with a magical gift, and that gift can burn your hands, break your bones, or destroy everything you love if you lose focus for half a second.

Magic in this world is not fireworks. It is work. Dangerous, physical, exhausting work. You grip invisible threads of reality, pull them taut, and hold them — knowing that the harder you pull, the worse it will be when something goes wrong. And something always goes wrong eventually.

This is a game about what power actually costs. Not just the physical cost of casting, but the moral cost of having it, the social cost of wielding it, and the existential weight of living in a world held together by something already stretched to its breaking point.

The Weavekeeper

One player is the Weavekeeper — the game's narrator, referee, and world-builder. The Weavekeeper controls all characters the players don't, sets scenes, determines difficulty, and is responsible for the world feeling alive, dangerous, and real. This role is equivalent to a Game Master (GM) in other systems.

PART TWO: THE WORLD IN BRIEF

Aethros and the Weave

Aethros is a world saturated with an invisible network of magical threads called leylines. Every stone, body of water, and breath of air is threaded through with them. Most people can't see them — but if you have the gift, you can feel them.

ANALOGY

Imagine a guitar. The whole instrument is the world. The strings are the leylines. You can't see them from outside — but if you have the gift, you can feel them. Grip one, pull it taut, and when you release it, something happens in the physical world. That's magic.

The catch: ten thousand years ago, the god Aedan won a cosmic war and stretched every remaining leyline to cover the damage. Every leyline is already at maximum tension. When you grip one and pull further, you're taking a string that's already about to snap and pushing it past its limit. This is why magic is dangerous — and also why even a small pull releases tremendous energy.

The Three Planes

- **Aethros:** The magical living world. Where the game takes place.
- **The Otherrealm:** A parallel mundane world with no leylines and no magic. A person born here cannot use magic in Aethros.
- **The Hollowing:** A pocket dimension prison holding the Shadow Threads Aedan removed, and Aradoth himself. It is leaking. This is the central problem of the era.

The Guild System

Magical society organizes itself into six major guilds, each with its own ranks, culture, and demands. Most people are civilian mages who use their affinity in everyday trades. Guild membership offers prestige, resources, and danger in roughly equal measure.

Guild	Role
The Scaled Guard	Military and law enforcement
The Thaumatarch	Mage specialists and researchers
The Highblood Circles	Nobility and governance

The Solar Temple	Healing and spiritual guidance
The Lorehall	Knowledge preservation and research
The Forgecrown	Magical crafting and enchantment

PART THREE: CORE MECHANICS

The Check

RULE

Roll d20 + Attribute Modifier. Meet or beat the Difficulty Class (DC) to succeed.

The Weavekeeper sets the DC based on how hard the task is. Here's what each number actually means in practice:

DC	Difficulty	What it means
8	Trivial	Something you'd do without thinking
11	Easy	Requires effort but well within your ability
14	Moderate	A genuine challenge for a competent person
17	Hard	Pushes most experts
20	Very Hard	Upper edge of reliable skill
23	Extreme	Upper edge of mortal capability
26+	Near-Impossible	Legends are made of this

ANALOGY

Think of the DC like a wall. Your d20 roll plus your skill modifier is how high you can jump. Sometimes the wall is low; sometimes it's a castle rampart. The die represents the chaos of the moment — your modifier is how well-prepared you are.

Harmony and Discord

Sometimes circumstances tilt the odds:

- **Harmony:** Roll two d20s and take the higher result. Applies when you have a significant advantage, great equipment, or ideal conditions.
- **Discord:** Roll two d20s and take the lower result. Applies when you're impaired, rushing, or working against the environment.

STACKING RULE

Multiple sources of Harmony or Discord don't stack — you always roll two dice regardless of how many sources you have. One Harmony + one Discord cancel each other out, and you roll a single d20 normally.

ANALOGY

It's the difference between best-of-two and worst-of-two. Harmony means luck's on your side; Discord means the universe is working against you today.

The Refinement Bonus (RB)

Your Refinement Bonus represents the accumulated weight of your training and experience. You add it to checks where you are Attuned to the relevant skill (more on this in the Skills section). It starts at +2 and grows as you level up.

Level	Refinement Bonus
1–2	+2
3–4	+3
5–6	+4
7–8	+5
9–10	+6

Thread Break and Misfire

- **Natural 20 — Thread Break:** The action succeeds spectacularly. In combat you deal maximum damage. In magic, the effect is more powerful or has a bonus. In social situations, something genuinely good happens for your side.
- **Natural 1 — Misfire:** The action fails regardless of modifiers. In combat, you miss badly or your weapon catches. In magic, this triggers an automatic Snapback Check. In social situations, you've made things meaningfully worse.

PART FOUR: LEVELING UP

THREADCAST uses a narrative leveling system. You level up when the Weavekeeper determines the party has accomplished something significant — survived a major threat, resolved a major story beat, or fundamentally grown as characters. Expect to level up roughly every 2–4 sessions at the start, and every 3–6 sessions at higher levels.

Each time you level up, you gain the following:

What You Gain	Details
+2 Vitality Points	Your maximum VP increases by 2.
+1 to one Attribute Score	Your choice. Can't exceed 20.
Refinement Bonus increases	See RB table — at levels 3, 5, 7, and 9.
Thread Pool grows	Because Thread Pool scales with Level, it automatically increases.
Safe Limit grows	Same reason — Safe Limit is Level + modifiers.
New String (odd levels)	At levels 3, 5, 7, 9 — unlock a new String with your Weavekeeper.
New Technique (even levels)	At levels 2, 4, 6, 8, 10 — learn a new Mode technique.
Secondary Mode (level 4)	You unlock a Secondary Mode of Resonance.
Tertiary Mode (level 7)	You unlock a Tertiary Mode of Resonance.

Level Milestones at a Glance

Level	RB	Notable Gain
1	+2	Starting character. 2 Strings, 2 Techniques, Primary Mode only.
2	+2	New Technique from your Primary Mode.
3	+3	New String. Refinement Bonus improves.
4	+3	Secondary Mode unlocked (normal rolls, no penalty or bonus).
5	+4	New String. Refinement Bonus improves.
6	+4	New Technique (from any unlocked Mode).
7	+5	New String. Tertiary Mode unlocked. Refinement Bonus improves.
8	+5	New Technique. Can now attempt 4-String weaves.
9	+6	New String. Refinement Bonus improves.
10	+6	New Technique. Mastery-level abilities become available.

UNPRACTICED MODES

Any Mode you haven't unlocked yet (not Primary, Secondary, or Tertiary) imposes Discord on all Thread Checks that use it. You can still attempt it — it just goes badly more often.

PART FIVE: CHARACTER CREATION

Follow these steps in order. Read through the whole process before you start — early decisions shape later ones.

Step 1: Choose Your Background

Your background determines where you came from. It grants attribute bonuses and starting Attuned Skills. You cannot change it once play begins.

Guild-Raised

You grew up inside or adjacent to one of the major guilds. You understand hierarchy, protocols, and how to navigate institutional power.

- **+Attributes:** +1 Control, +1 Acuity, +1 Presence
- **Starting Attuned Skills:** Guild Protocol, Lore, Discernment
- **Starting Guild Rank:** One rank above minimum in your chosen guild

Civilian Mage

Your magic was always practical. You used it to work, to trade, to provide.

- **+Attributes:** +1 Control, +1 Resilience, +1 any
- **Starting Attuned Skills:** Trade Craft, Survival, Street Sense
- **Starting Guild Rank:** None (civilian license only)

Self-Taught

No academy, no master, no safety net. You figured it out yourself through trial, error, and injuries that still ache in cold weather.

- **+Attributes:** +2 Thread Sense, +1 Potency
- **Starting Attuned Skills:** Weave Reading, Survival, one of your choice
- **Starting Penalty:** Begin with 1 level of Burnout (recoverable; this represents small accumulated damage from learning without guidance)
- **Unique Benefit:** You may choose one Unorthodox Technique — a method that breaks standard rules in a limited way (work with your Weavekeeper to design this)

Noble-Born

The Highblood Circles shaped your childhood — etiquette, bloodline politics, the constant weight of inherited expectation.

- **+Attributes:** +2 Presence, +1 Acuity, +1 any
- **Starting Attuned Skills:** Discernment, Lore, Guild Protocol
- **Starting Guild Rank:** Gildthane in the Highblood Circles (can hold concurrently with another guild)

Military Family

The Scaled Guard or blade-culture. You were trained in violence before magic — or at the same time.

- **+Attributes:** +2 Resilience, +1 Acuity, +1 Potency
- **Starting Attuned Skills:** Combat Forms, Grit, Survival
- **Starting Guild Rank:** Ashborn in the Scaled Guard

Scholar's Lineage

The Lorehall's culture runs in your veins. Precision matters.

- **+Attributes:** +2 Acuity, +2 Thread Sense
- **Starting Attuned Skills:** Lore, Weave Reading, Inscription
- **Starting Guild Rank:** Loreling in the Lorehall

Temple-Raised

The Solar Temple formed your understanding of magic as something sacred and costly — to be wielded with care, never with carelessness.

- **+Attributes:** +1 Presence, +1 Control, +1 Thread Sense, +1 any
- **Starting Attuned Skills:** Anatomy of Magic, Discernment, Ward Craft
- **Starting Guild Rank:** Ashpetal in the Solar Temple

Step 2: Assign Attributes

You have 78 points to distribute across six attributes. Minimum score per attribute: 8. Maximum at character creation: 16 (before background bonuses). After applying bonuses, the absolute maximum is 18.

Attribute	Abbreviation	What it governs
Potency	POT	Raw magical strength. How powerful your effects can be.
Control	CTR	Magical precision. Accuracy, Ward Rating, combining Strings.
Resilience	RES	Physical toughness. Vitality Points, Guard Rating, recovery speed.
Acuity	ACU	Mental sharpness. Initiative, perception, tactical assessment.
Presence	PRE	Force of will. Social checks, leadership, fear resistance.
Thread Sense	THS	Ability to feel leylines. Detecting magic, signatures, corruption.

Convert your attribute score to a modifier using this formula: $(\text{Score} - 10) \div 2$, round down.
Quick reference:

Score	Modifier
8–9	–1
10–11	+0
12–13	+1
14–15	+2
16–17	+3
18–19	+4
20	+5

Step 3: Choose Your Affinity

Your Affinity is the type of leyline your blood resonates with. It determines what your magic can affect. You cannot change it — you were born with it.

Tier	Affinities	Notes
Common	Fire, Water, Earth, Air, Metal, Wood, Plant	Entire academy departments; many practitioners.
Uncommon	Ice, Lightning, Glass, Stone, Sound, Light, Heat, Pressure	Respected specializations; predictable but valuable.
Rare	Gravity, Dreams, Memory, Emotion, Silence, Time	Requires Weavekeeper approval. Unique roleplay challenges.

Forbidden	Blood, Entropy, Decay, Void	Shadow Thread affinities. Story-path only; full Weavekeeper discussion required.
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Step 4: Define Your Strings (With Your Weavekeeper)

Within your Affinity, there are multiple Strings — distinct aspects of that affinity, each with its own character and capabilities. A fire mage doesn’t just “do fire magic” — they access specific leylines within the fire family.

ANALOGY

Think of your Affinity as the instrument you play. The Strings are the individual notes on that instrument. A guitarist doesn’t play “guitar sounds” — they play specific strings to produce specific notes.

HOW STRINGS WORK WITH YOUR WEAVEKEEPER

You don’t pick Strings from a fixed list. Instead, once you’ve chosen your Affinity, sit down with your Weavekeeper and tell them about your character — their history, personality, what draws them to magic, how they first experienced it.

The Weavekeeper then designs 4–5 Strings for your Affinity that fit your specific character. A fire mage who grew up in a forge will have different Strings than one who survived a house fire as a child. The Strings reflect who you are, not just what element you control.

You begin with access to 2 of your Strings. You unlock additional Strings at levels 3, 5, 7, and 9.

As a general guide, most Affinities have Strings along these lines: a raw power String (the destructive or forceful aspect), a subtle or environmental String (background influence), a precision or shaping String, an interaction String (how it affects materials or creatures), and an aftermath or transformation String (what it leaves behind). Your Weavekeeper will tailor these to your character.

Step 5: Choose Your Mode of Resonance

Your Mode is how you interact with leylines — your instinctive technique. Your Affinity is what instrument you play; your Mode is how you play it. Choose one Primary Mode from the Eight (see Part Eight for full detail):

Mode	Character	Good For
1. Striker	Violent displacement	Offense, explosions, raw force
2. Anchor	Tension stabilization	Defense, barriers, holding ground
3. Slider	Controlled repositioning	Mobility, evasion, precision
4. Binder	Thread interlocking	Enchanting, constructs, conditional effects
5. Shearer	Abrasive interference	Counterspells, destruction, dispelling
6. Tensioner	Progressive over-extension	Massive power, siege-breaking, desperation
7. Imprinter	Pattern imposition	Traps, zone effects, altered physics
8. Conductor	Internal channeling	Self-enhancement, physical transformation

Your Primary Mode gives you Harmony on all Thread Checks using that Mode. You begin with two Techniques from your Primary Mode (see Part Eight).

Step 6: Choose Your Path

- **Guild Path:** You are formally affiliated with one of the six guilds. Your background may already determine which. Guild membership grants access to resources, training, and assignments — and comes with obligations.
- **Civilian Path:** You use your affinity in a trade or profession. Describe what work you do. You have a Novice License and operate independently. More freedom, less prestige.

Step 7: Choose Your Attuned Skills

Your background grants 3 Attuned skills automatically. Choose 1 additional skill from the full list (Part Six). Total starting Attuned skills: 4.

Step 8: Calculate Derived Statistics

Statistic	Formula	What It Represents
Vitality Points (VP)	RES score + 8 (at Level 1), +2 per level	Your health. When this hits 0, you go down.

Thread Pool (TP)	(POT mod + CTR mod + Level) × 2, min 6	Your magical fuel tank. Exceed it and you Snapback.
Safe Limit (SL)	POT mod + CTR mod + Level	How much tension you can hold without active danger.
Ward Rating (WR)	10 + CTR modifier	What attackers must beat to hit you magically.
Guard Rating (GR)	10 + RES modifier	What attackers must beat to hit you physically.

Step 9: Define Your Magical Signature

Every mage has a unique Signature — an involuntary visual and/or auditory manifestation that appears whenever they cast. Choose or describe:

- **Visual Component:** A shimmer of color, geometric patterns, sparks, heat distortion, a specific light quality, trailing shadow, frost patterns, etc.
- **Auditory Component:** A musical tone, crackling, humming, whispering, bells, a note that matches your heartbeat, a sudden silence, etc.

Your Signature cannot be changed. It can be suppressed at significant cost (see Part Nine). Experienced mages can identify each other by Signature alone.

Step 10: Name and Final Details

Name your character. Determine their age (awakening typically occurs at 10–16; most adventurers are 16–35). Describe their appearance — including the marks of their magic: scarred hands, calluses, Lichtenberg figures, the subtle physical wear of someone whose profession costs the body.

PART SIX: ATTRIBUTES

Potency (POT)

Raw magical strength. The force you can exert on a leyline. How far you can pull before losing your grip.

ANALOGY

Imagine pulling back a bowstring. Potency is how strong your arms are. Two archers with the same bow and same technique — the stronger one draws it further. Further draw = more power when released.

Governs: How powerful your magical effects can be; maximum Power Level you can safely attempt; Thread Pool size.

Potency is largely inherited — a product of your bloodline, your birthplace, and luck. It can improve with experience, but it's the hardest attribute to change.

Control (CTR)

Magical precision. Learned technique. The difference between hitting what you're aiming at and destroying the room you're standing in.

ANALOGY

Using the same bow — Control is your form. A strong archer with bad form shoots wildly. A weaker archer with perfect form hits the mark every time. If you can only have one, most masters say: choose Control.

Governs: Accuracy of magical effects; DC for Thread Checks; Ward Rating; ability to combine multiple Strings.

Control is entirely learned. Every hour of practice, every scar from getting it wrong, every lesson from someone who knew better.

Resilience (RES)

Physical toughness. Capacity to absorb punishment — both conventional and magical. The body's ability to recover.

Governs: Vitality Points; Guard Rating; resistance to Snapback damage; physical fatigue recovery speed.

Acuity (ACU)

Mental sharpness. Perceptive, analytical, tactical. The ability to read situations, remember things that matter, and act before others have finished thinking.

Governs: Initiative; knowledge and perception checks; tactical assessment; identifying magical signatures.

Presence (PRE)

Force of will. Social authority. The quality that makes people believe you, follow you, or be afraid of you — whichever you need.

Governs: Social checks; leadership; resistance to fear and psychological effects; holding your nerve under extreme magical strain.

Thread Sense (THS)

The ability to feel leylines — their location, tension, character, and current state. The mage's equivalent of a musician's ear.

Governs: Detecting nearby magic; reading magical signatures; environmental casting awareness; sensing Hollowing corruption.

PART SEVEN: SKILLS

Being Attuned to a skill means you add your Refinement Bonus to checks using that skill, in addition to the relevant attribute modifier. Skills represent specific areas of training.

Skill	Linked Attribute	Used For
Thread Reach	THS	Connecting with distant or deeply buried leylines
Surge	POT	Pushing a magical effect to maximum power in a single burst
Weave Reading	THS	Analyzing magical environments, residue, and anomalies
Signature Suppression	CTR	Minimizing your casting signature to avoid detection
Strand Awareness	THS	Detecting mages' signatures; identifying who cast what
Ward Craft	CTR	Creating protective barriers and defensive magical structures
Inscription	ACU	Creating persistent enchantments, magical texts, and rune-work
Anatomy of Magic	ACU	Healing, understanding how magic interacts with biology
Combat Forms	ACU	Trained physical fighting; weapon technique; martial coordination
Swift Hands	CTR	Rapid, precise physical actions; sleight of hand; quick draw
Grit	RES	Enduring sustained physical or magical stress without breaking
Discernment	ACU	Reading people; detecting deception; assessing intentions
Lore	ACU	Historical knowledge; magical theory; guild protocols
Guild Protocol	PRE	Navigating institutional hierarchies, rules, and expectations
Street Sense	ACU	Urban navigation; information networks; knowing who to talk to
Survival	RES	Wilderness navigation; endurance in harsh environments
Presence	PRE	Commanding social situations; leadership; inspiring or intimidating
Trade Craft	ACU	Crafting, enchanting items, professional magical application

PART EIGHT: MODES OF RESONANCE

If your Affinity is what you play, your Mode of Resonance is how you play it. Every interaction with a leyline falls into one of eight fundamental categories — these are the physical techniques of leyline manipulation.

MODE PROFICIENCY

Primary Mode: Harmony on all Thread Checks using this Mode.
Secondary Modes (2) (unlocked at Level 4): Normal rolls, no bonus or penalty.
Tertiary Modes (2) (unlocked at Level 7): Normal rolls.
Unpracticed Mode: Discord on Thread Checks. You can still try — it just goes wrong more often.

Mode One: Striker

You hook a leyline, yank it violently out of alignment, and release it instantly. The string snaps back to equilibrium with explosive force.

ANALOGY

Plucking a guitar string hard enough to make it ring across a concert hall — except the string is the fabric of reality and the “sound” is a shockwave.

What It Produces

- Kinetic force discharge (throws, shockwaves, impacts)
- Thermal spikes (flash fires, sudden boiling, instant freezing)
- Elemental bursts of raw affinity energy

Quick Stats

Thread Check: POT mod + RB (Surge)
Damage Dice: 2d12 (scales by Power Level)
Range: 30–60 ft (extendable by Tension)

Striker Techniques

Choose 2 at character creation if Striker is your Primary Mode.

Technique	Effect
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Groundbreaker	Force directed downward; all targets in 10 ft knocked Prone
Focused Shot	Single target only; increase damage die one step (d10 → d12)
Chain Discharge	Energy arcs to a second target for half damage
Quickfire	Reduce Tension cost by 2; reduce damage die by one step
Overclock	Spend 2 extra Tension; double damage on hit, but Snapback Check required regardless

FAILURE MODE

Snapback is kinetic and elemental. Expect broken bones, ruptured muscle, or burn damage. Strikers have the highest injury rate of any Mode.

Mode Two: Anchor

You grip a leyline and hold it absolutely still — preventing the natural vibration that would otherwise occur. You become the pin that holds reality in place at that point.

ANALOGY

Holding a guitar string down hard against the fret. The note doesn't ring out — it stops. Everything near that fret is held firm while you maintain your grip.

What It Produces

- Reinforced barriers that cannot be crossed
- Gravity wells that pin objects in place
- Stabilized environments (critical for healing)
- Foundation structures other mages can build on

Quick Stats

Thread Check: RES mod + RB (Ward Craft)
Barrier VP: 8 + (POT mod × 2) + Level
Duration: Maintained while you concentrate
Note: Can't take Major Actions while maintaining

Anchor Techniques

Choose 2 at character creation if Anchor is your Primary Mode.

Technique	Effect
Fortify	Barrier VP doubled; costs 4 additional Tension

Walking Anchor	Reduce barrier strength by half; move at half speed while maintaining
Shared Ground	Extend Anchor's stability to protect allies within 10 feet
Surge Absorb	Reaction: Spend Tension equal to incoming magical damage; absorb it into the Anchor
Anchor Pin	Focus on a creature or object; it cannot move for your concentration duration

FAILURE MODE

When an Anchor collapses, all accumulated stress releases at once — potentially crushing the caster and scrambling leyline connection for hours.

Mode Three: Slider

Instead of pulling perpendicular to the leyline, you grip it and move along its length — repositioning where the tension manifests rather than changing how much there is.

ANALOGY

Sliding your finger along a guitar string rather than plucking it. You're not changing the tension — you're moving the point of contact, which changes what the vibration produces and where it occurs.

What It Produces

- Deflection of incoming force (attacks veer away)
- Momentum transfer (take speed and apply it elsewhere)
- Short-range spatial repositioning

Quick Stats

Thread Check: CTR mod + RB (Swift Hands)
Movement: POT mod × 5 ft per Tension spent
Deflect: On success, redirect one attack within 15 ft

Slider Techniques

Choose 2 at character creation if Slider is your Primary Mode.

Technique	Effect
Phase Step	Move up to 30 ft as a Minor Action, ignoring difficult terrain
Ricochet	Redirect a projectile to bounce to a second target for half damage
Momentum Steal	On successful deflection: attacker loses their next Minor Action

Ghost Walk	Spend 3 Tension; invisible to magical detection for 1 round
Echo Slide	Move up to 60 ft; suffer Discord on all checks until your next turn

FAILURE MODE

Losing your grip mid-slide causes violent spatial shear — dislocated joints, torn ligaments, or internal displacement. The pain is described as being pulled apart from the inside.

Mode Four: Binder

You grip multiple leylines simultaneously and force them to intertwine — creating a unified system that persists beyond your casting. You are programming the Weave.

ANALOGY

Braiding strings together so they behave as one rope. The combined structure is stronger and more complex than any individual thread — but braiding takes time, skill, and your complete attention.

What It Produces

- Fusion magic (combining elements for new effects)
- Conditional rules (“when X happens, trigger Y”)
- Persistent magical constructs — golems, enchanted items
- Trap and ward construction

Quick Stats

Thread Check: ACU mod + RB (Inscription)
Duration: Permanent until broken
Each extra condition: +2 to Thread Check DC

Binder Techniques

Choose 2 at character creation if Binder is your Primary Mode.

Technique	Effect
Conditional Lock	Bind an effect that triggers on a specific event; can be set and left
Fusion Weave	Combine two Strings for a complex effect without Discord penalty
Resilient Binding	Enchantment VP = CTR score; must be destroyed before the effect breaks
Collaborative Matrix	Your Binding can incorporate another mage’s Tension contribution

Living Ward	Create a ward that adapts to threats, updating its conditions automatically
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FAILURE MODE

When a Binding collapses, the intertwined threads thrash violently. Chaotic magic erupts in all directions. The caster suffers feedback damage and may permanently hear certain strings as subtly wrong.

Mode Five: Shearer

You introduce deliberate friction — working against the natural grain of the leylines, rubbing and grinding threads against each other or against material objects.

ANALOGY

Playing a guitar string with sandpaper instead of a pick. You create erosion and grinding — rather than a clean note, you're wearing the string down.

What It Produces

- Erosion and decay — rapid aging, disintegration
- Corrosion of magical effects (counterspelling)
- Cutting through materials without physical contact

Quick Stats

Thread Check: POT mod + RB (Ward Craft, inverse)

Counterspell: Thread Check vs original caster's result

Disintegration: 2d10 per round to a non-living target

Shearer Techniques

Choose 2 at character creation if Shearer is your Primary Mode.

Technique	Effect
Unravel	Remove one active enchantment; no combat roll if unopposed
Selective Decay	Target only specific material (only the rust, not the sword)
Scrub	Cleanse magical contamination or Hollowing corruption from an area
Surgical Application	Precision mode: deal 3d6 to one specific target, no area effect
Dead Zone	Suppress leyline activity in 20 ft radius for 1 minute; all magic costs double

FAILURE MODE

Destructive forces turn on the caster. Rapid aging, spontaneous necrosis, molecular collapse. Shearer failures are among the most horrifying to witness.

Mode Six: Tensioner

You stretch a leyline far beyond its normal tolerance and hold it there, accumulating tension over multiple rounds. When you release, the power is exponentially amplified.

ANALOGY

Drawing a bowstring back to an impossible distance over several seconds. Every second you hold, the potential energy increases. The shot, when it finally releases, is capable of things a normal draw couldn't achieve. But every second also increases the risk that your arms give out.

What It Produces

- Amplified versions of any other effect
- Environmental manipulation (storms, seismic shifts)
- Siege-breaking force; effects felt for miles

Charging Rules

1 round = Power Level 3
2 rounds = Power Level 4
3+ rounds = Power Level 5
Each round: damage steps up AND make Snapback Check

Tensioner Techniques

Choose 2 at character creation if Tensioner is your Primary Mode.

Technique	Effect
Controlled Release	Release partial tension; deal half max damage but reset charge to half
Iron Grip	+3 to Snapback Checks while charging
Overcharge	Maximum damage becomes 3× base; Snapback on any failed check is at maximum severity
Split Discharge	Divide accumulated energy between up to 3 targets
Pressure Field	Hold tension as a zone; everything in 20 ft takes ongoing pressure damage

FAILURE MODE

Apocalyptic snapback. The built-up energy has nowhere to go but through you. Expect cardiac distress, neural overload, Lichtenberg scarring, and permanent attribute damage.

Mode Seven: Imprinter

You press a specific pattern onto the leylines themselves — a temporary stamp that alters how reality behaves in a localized area. You are writing temporary new physics into a patch of the world.

ANALOGY

Putting a capo on a specific fret of a guitar. You haven't changed the strings — you've changed the rules for what notes that section can produce. When the capo is removed (or falls off), the rules revert.

What It Produces

- Short-term physics alterations (low gravity, silence)
- Delayed or triggered effects
- Zone defenses and environmental illusions

Quick Stats

Thread Check: ACU mod + RB (Inscription)

Duration: Level + CTR modifier minutes

Area: Up to 20 ft radius per 3 Tension spent

Imprinter Techniques

Choose 2 at character creation if Imprinter is your Primary Mode.

Technique	Effect
Trigger Lock	Effect activates only when a specific condition is met
Extended Pattern	Triple the duration of an Imprint; costs 4 additional Tension
Layered Reality	Stack two different Imprints in same area; requires two successful Checks
Mobile Imprint	Pattern follows a specific person or object rather than a fixed location
Phantom Ground	Create an illusion of terrain that fools all senses including magical detection

FAILURE MODE

When an Imprint collapses, the pattern imprints on the caster instead. Fire mages might spontaneously ignite; stone mages might find their limbs temporarily petrified.

Mode Eight: Conductor

Instead of releasing leyline energy outward, you route it through your own body. You become the medium through which magical force travels — a wire conducting enormous current.

ANALOGY

Plugging yourself into the electrical outlet instead of plugging in a lamp. All that power flows through you. You become extraordinary. The lamp socket doesn't burn out — but wires do.

What It Produces

- Superhuman physical attributes (strength, speed, endurance)
- Perception expansion beyond normal limits
- Accelerated healing mid-combat
- Partial transformation — becoming partially elemental

Quick Stats

Thread Check: RES mod + RB (Grit)

Enhancement: 2 Tension = +2 to one physical attribute (1 round)

Healing: 3 Tension = recover 1d8 + POT mod VP (Minor Action)

Conductor Techniques

Choose 2 at character creation if Conductor is your Primary Mode.

Technique	Effect
Iron Body	Guard Rating increases by CTR modifier while Conducting
Burst Speed	One movement this round is tripled; costs 3 Tension
Elemental Touch	Unarmed attacks deal affinity-typed damage for 1 round
Absorb and Channel	When you take affinity-matched elemental damage, convert half to Tension

Burning Presence	While Conducting, signature becomes visible; enemies targeting you must make PRE Check (DC 14) or suffer Discord on their attack
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FAILURE MODE

Internal overload. Spontaneous combustion, liquefaction, petrification, neural burnout depending on affinity. Survivors describe burning out from the inside for years afterward.

PART NINE: THE TENSION SYSTEM

Tension is the core resource of leyline magic. Every time you cast, you grip a leyline and stretch it — increasing its tension to release energy. That strain accumulates in you. Your body is the intermediary between the leyline and the effect. After casting, some of that strain stays with you until you rest and safely release it.

ANALOGY

Imagine carrying a compressed spring in your hands. The harder and longer you press it, the more energy it holds. When you release it (the spell), most of the energy goes where you direct it — but some of the vibration stays in your hands, making the next spell slightly less controlled. Stack enough of these and your hands are shaking so hard you can't aim anymore.

Thread Pool and Safe Limit

Two numbers matter: how much you can hold, and how much you can hold safely.

Stat	Formula	What Happens When You Exceed It
Thread Pool (TP)	$(\text{POT mod} + \text{CTR mod} + \text{Level}) \times 2$, minimum 6	Automatic Snapback. All that tension releases through you.
Safe Limit (SL)	$\text{POT mod} + \text{CTR mod} + \text{Level}$	Must make a Strain Check each turn until you release tension.

STRAIN CHECK

When your current Tension exceeds your Safe Limit, roll d20 + RES modifier at the start of each of your turns.

$DC = 10 + (\text{current Tension} - \text{Safe Limit})$.

On failure: Snapback (roll on the Snapback Table).

How to Cast

Casting in THREADCAST is designed to be flexible and descriptive. There is no fixed spell list — you describe what you want to do, and the rules determine whether you succeed and at what cost.

Step	What You Do
1. Describe your effect	Tell the table what you're doing with your Affinity and Mode. Be specific — the Weavekeeper may adjust difficulty based on how creative or difficult the effect is.
2. Choose a Power Level	From the table below. Higher Power Levels = more dramatic effects, higher Tension cost, harder roll.
3. Choose your Strings	Declare which of your Strings you're using. One String is standard. Two or more Strings produce Weaving (see below).
4. Roll your Thread Check	d20 + CTR modifier + RB (if Attuned to the relevant skill). Beat the Power Level DC.
5. Resolve the result	Success: the effect happens, add Tension Cost to your total. Failure: roll on the Mishap Table. Natural 1: Snapback Table.
6. Check your Tension	If you're now above your Safe Limit, you'll need to roll a Strain Check at the start of your next turn.

Power Levels

Power Levels represent scale, not specific spells. The same Power Level 3 effect could be a concentrated lance of fire, a wave of compressed air that scatters a crowd, or a wall of stone rising from the ground. The Power Level sets the mechanical cost; you narrate the flavour.

PL	Name	Tension Cost	Thread Check DC	Scale	Examples
1	Flicker	1	8	Trivial	Light a candle, push a small object, warm someone's hands, feel a nearby leyline
2	Touch	3	11	Room-scale	Heat a room, hold a door shut, create a small shield, lift a chair
3	Surge	6	14	Significant	Force-throw a person, create a lasting barrier, deal serious combat damage
4	Fierce	10	17	Major	Collapse a wall, affect a whole crowd, reshape part of a building

5	Breaking	15	20	Catastrophic	Siege-scale destruction, reshape terrain, effects felt for miles
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YOUR MAXIMUM SAFE POWER LEVEL

Without penalty: Level + (POT modifier ÷ 3), round down, minimum 1.

Attempting a Power Level above this is possible, but always at Discord.

Example: A Level 3 mage with POT modifier +2 can safely attempt Power Level 4 (3 + 0 = 3, +1 for the partial modifier = 4 rounded down is 3 — anything higher is at Discord).

When in doubt, the Weavekeeper can help you calculate this.

Weaving: Using Multiple Strings

When you cast using two or more of your Strings simultaneously, you access effects that neither String alone could produce. This is called Weaving.

ANALOGY

Playing a chord on a guitar — each string contributes, but they interact. Some chords ring beautifully. Some produce dissonance. A chord you've practiced sounds smooth; one you haven't sounds like you dropped the guitar.

Strings Used	Roll	Effect	Tension Cost
Two Strings	Normal Thread Check	Effect is enhanced beyond what either String alone could do	Normal cost
Three Strings	Thread Check at Discord	Effect is dramatically enhanced if successful	Double normal cost
Four Strings	Thread Check at Discord (Level 7+)	Catastrophic potential; top 5% of mages can do this reliably	Triple normal cost

New Strings become available at odd levels (3, 5, 7, 9). Each time, sit down with your Weavekeeper and discuss what aspect of your Affinity your character has grown into. What have they learned? What have they experienced? The new String should reflect that.

The Mishap Table

When you fail a Thread Check but don't roll a natural 1, roll d6:

d6	Result	Effect
1–2	Flinch	Effect fails; lose your Minor Action next turn; 1d4 feedback damage
3–4	Backlash	Effect occurs at half power; Discord on all Thread Checks until your next Mend
5	Wild Release	Effect occurs at full power but hits the wrong target (Weavekeeper's choice)
6	Tension Spike	Add the Tension Cost twice instead of once; trigger a Strain Check immediately

The Snapback Table

When you roll a natural 1 on a Thread Check, or when a Strain Check fails, roll d12:

d12	Result	Effect
1–2	Flinch	1d6 affinity-typed damage; lose your Minor Action next turn
3–4	Burn	2d8 affinity-typed damage; –1 to all Thread Checks until Mend (hands are painful)
5–6	Rupture	2d10 damage; RES Check (DC 14) or suffer Shaking Hands condition
7–8	Discharge	3d10 damage; effect releases uncontrolled in a random direction (roll d8 for direction)
9–10	Overload	3d12 damage; Stunned until end of next turn; all Tension resets to 0 violently
11	Collapse	4d12 damage; fall unconscious for 1 minute; gain 2 levels of Burnout
12	Total Break	Maximum possible damage; roll on the Permanent Injury Table; gain 3 levels of Burnout

AFFINITY-TYPED SNAPBACK

Snapback damage reflects the nature of the leyline you were working with:

Fire: Burns; risk of igniting clothing.

Water: Hydraulic pressure; internal fluid damage; drowning sensation.

Earth/Stone: Kinetic impact; broken bones; blunt force.

Lightning: Electrical discharge through the nervous system; Lichtenberg scars.

Shadow/Void: Cold damage; necrotic tissue; psychological trauma.

Releasing Tension

As a Minor Action, you can deliberately and safely release accumulated Tension, reducing your current total by up to your Safe Limit. This produces a visible burst of your Signature — always noticeable, never subtle.

After a Mend (a 10-minute rest), your current Tension resets to zero.

Internal Magic

Small effects that don't require gripping leylines at all — they draw on your personal reserves. Internal magic doesn't cost Tension and doesn't risk Snapback, but the effects are minor and can't be used too frequently.

- **Examples:** Sensing temperature changes, warming your hands, lighting a candle, knowing when something is about to go wrong with your affinity type
- **Limit:** More than 3 internal uses per hour imposes 1 level of Fatigue

Collaborative Casting

Two or more mages can pool their Thread Pools for large-scale effects. One mage is the Lead — they make all Thread Checks and direct the effect. Supporting mages contribute Tension Points from their own Thread Pools.

- Each supporting mage makes a CTR Check (DC 12) each round they contribute.
- If a supporting mage fails, the Lead must immediately make a Strain Check (DC 15).
- Combined effects can reach Power Level 5+, and ritual effects can reshape significant areas of reality.

Magical Burnout

Extended casting, failed Snapbacks, or pushing past your limits accumulates Burnout. This is separate from physical Fatigue.

Level	Name	Effect
1	Frayed	Discord on all Thread Checks
2	Stretched	Discord on all attribute checks; casting costs +1 Tension
3	Strained	Speed halved; Discord on all checks; Safe Limit halved
4	Cracked	Cannot cast above Power Level 2; Ward Rating -3; barely functional
5	Shattered	Cannot take Major Actions; barely conscious

6	Burned Out	Unconscious; requires magical healing; may suffer permanent TP reduction
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Each level of Burnout requires one Full Recovery (8 hours sleep + a meal) to reduce by one level. Levels 5–6 may require additional magical healing from a licensed healer.

PART TEN: VITALITY, INJURY & RECOVERY

Vitality Points (VP)

Your VP represents your capacity to absorb punishment before you go down.

RULE

VP at Level 1 = RES score + 8. You gain +2 maximum VP each time you level up.

When you reach 0 VP, you fall Incapacitated — unconscious and unable to act. If you take damage equal to your maximum VP while already at 0, you die.

DEATH'S EDGE

While Incapacitated, roll d20 at the start of each round:

On 10+: you stabilize (no longer losing VP).

On a natural 20: you regain 1 VP and regain consciousness.

Three failures before stabilizing = death.

Wounds

Some attacks and Snapback results cause Wounds — specific injuries beyond HP damage. When you take 20% or more of your maximum VP in a single hit, roll d6 on the Wound Table:

d6	Wound	Effect
1	Bruised Ribs	Discord on Grit checks; –5 ft movement
2	Hand Injury	Discord on Thread Checks and weapon attacks
3	Leg Strike	Speed halved; Discord on Combat Forms checks
4	Head Ring	Discord on ACU checks; difficulty concentrating

5	Internal Shock	Cannot use Power Level 4–5 magic until healed
6	Serious Wound	Require medical attention within 1 hour or suffer 1 Fatigue per hour

Permanent Injuries

When you roll 12 on the Snapback Table, roll d6 on the Permanent Injury Table:

d6	Injury	Mechanical Effect
1	Lichtenberg Scars	No mechanical effect; significant cosmetic marking
2	Nerve Damage (Hands)	Permanent –1 to CTR modifier; partially mitigable with specialized gloves
3	Leyline Misread	Permanent Discord on Thread Sense checks of a specific type
4	Lost Thread	One specific String is permanently inaccessible
5	Reduced Ceiling	Thread Pool maximum reduced by 4 permanently
6	The Shakes	Discord on all Thread Checks; can be stabilized (not cured) with long-term care

Recovery

Rest Type	Duration	What It Restores
Mend	10 minutes	Tension resets to 0; recover 1d6 + RES mod VP (spend a Recovery Die); end Shaking Hands and Burned conditions. Does not reduce Burnout.
Full Recovery	8+ hours + a meal	All VP recovered; all Recovery Dice refilled; Burnout reduced by 1 level; Fatigue reduced by 1 level.
Magical Healing	Major Action	Anatomy of Magic check (DC 12); recover 2d8 + CTR mod VP. Specialized healer treatment: reduce Burnout by 2 levels per session.

Recovery Dice: You have (RES modifier + 2) Recovery Dice. These refill on a Full Recovery.

PART ELEVEN: COMBAT AND CONFLICT

The Round

Combat is divided into Rounds of approximately 6 seconds each. A round proceeds in three phases:

- **Call Phase:** The Weavekeeper announces the situation; players declare intended actions.
- **Action Phase:** Actions resolve in Initiative order.
- **End Phase:** Conditions tick; ongoing effects apply; Strain Checks if needed.

Initiative

RULE

At the start of combat, roll d20 + ACU modifier. Act in descending order. Ties: players act before NPCs.

You can delay your Initiative by up to 5, placing yourself lower in order. Some Slider and Imprinter techniques allow you to act outside normal Initiative.

Action Economy

Action	What You Can Do
Major Action	Cast magic at Power Level 2+; make a weapon attack; use a complex technique
Minor Action	Move up to your speed (30 ft); release Tension; draw a weapon; use an item; cast at Power Level 1; activate a passive technique
Reaction	One per round; triggered by a specific event; some techniques use reactions

Attack Checks and Defense

- **Physical Attack:** Roll d20 + relevant attribute mod (Combat Forms adds RB if Attuned) vs. target's Guard Rating (GR = 10 + RES modifier)
- **Magical Attack:** Roll d20 + CTR modifier (Thread Check with Mode applied) vs. target's Ward Rating (WR = 10 + CTR modifier)

Damage

Source	Damage
Unarmed strike	1d4 + RES modifier
Light weapon (dagger, short blade)	1d6 + ACU modifier
Standard weapon (sword, spear)	1d8 + RES modifier
Heavy weapon (greatsword)	1d10 + RES modifier
Magical: Power Level 1	1d6 + POT modifier
Magical: Power Level 2	2d6 + POT modifier
Magical: Power Level 3	2d8 + POT modifier
Magical: Power Level 4	2d10 + POT modifier
Magical: Power Level 5	2d12 + POT modifier

Combat Conditions

Condition	Effect
Shaking Hands	Discord on all Thread Checks; ends on Mend
Stunned	Cannot take actions; auto-fail Strain Checks; ends at start of your next turn
Prone	Discord on attack checks; GR -3 against melee; move speed halved
Frightened	Discord on all checks while source of fear is visible
Burned	Take 1d4 fire damage at start of each turn; ends when extinguished or on Mend
Pinned	Cannot move; can still act (Anchor mode typically causes this)
Corrupted	Hollowing taint affecting you; Thread Sense distorted; see Part Thirteen

PART TWELVE: GUILDS, RANKS & SOCIETY

Guild Rank determines your access to resources, social standing, and how NPCs treat you. Advancing requires: time in rank, a Rank Trial (a skill challenge or demonstration), and an endorsement from a higher-ranked mage.

Target Rank	Trial DC
Rank 7–6	12
Rank 5–4	15
Rank 3	18
Rank 2	21
Rank 1	25

The Scaled Guard — Military Guild

“We hold the line so everyone else can pretend there isn’t one.”

Rank	Title	Equivalent
1	Wyrmlord	Supreme Commander
2	Drakeward	Colonel / Regional Commander
3	Talonarch	Captain / Elite Leader
4	Steelfang	Lieutenant / Squad Leader
5	Ironbrand	Sergeant
6	Embercloak	Soldier
7	Ashborn	Recruit / Trainee

- **Benefits:** Military gear, combat training access, legal authority, combat magic license, pension
- **Obligations:** Follow orders; accept deployment; maintain secrecy on classified matters; respond to emergencies

The Thaumatarch — Mage Guild

“Every problem is a variable. Every variable is solvable.”

Rank	Title	Equivalent
1	Archon	Guildmaster / Archmage
2	Magister	Senior Mage / Master
3	Runecaller	Mid-tier Specialist
4	Sigilist	Journeyman Mage
5	Gleamer	Apprentice
6	Spark	Initiate

- **Benefits:** Research access, Spire facilities, advanced training, dangerous-application license, high salary
- **Obligations:** Take assignments; provide expertise on request; don't publish classified research without approval

The Highblood Circles — Nobility

“Power is inherited, influence is earned, and the gap between the two is where everything interesting happens.”

Rank	Title	Equivalent
1	Thronelord / Thronelady	King/Queen or Grand Duke
2	Glassduke / Glassdame	Duke/Duchess
3	Highborne	Marquis / Count
4	Stonewarden	Baron / Baroness
5	Gildthane	Knight / Minor Noble
6	Vellum	Noble by deed
7	Scion	Noble-born heir

The Solar Temple — Healing and Faith

Rank	Title	Role
1	Solanarch	High Priest / Spiritual Leader

2	Luminary	Regional head of temples
3	Dawnseer	Visionary / oracle
4	Flameward	Senior priest / defender
5	Lightbearer	Priest who leads ceremonies
6	Gracehand	Healer and caretaker
7	Whisperkin	Acolyte
8	Ashpetal	Novitiate

The Lorehall — Scholar's Guild

Rank	Title	Role
1	Archivarch	Head of the guild
2	Scriptor	Master of texts; leads research
3	Inkwright	Active researcher
4	Pagewarden	Keeper of records
5	Glyphscribe	Enchanter of scrolls
6	Quillborn	Junior researcher
7	Loreling	Trainee

The Forgecrown — Artificer's Guild

Rank	Title	Role
1	Forgeheart	Grandmaster
2	Artifex	Master craftsman
3	Glyphmason	Enchantment specialist
4	Metalmind	Senior crafter; leads workshops
5	Shapebinder	General artificer
6	Cindertouch	Apprentice
7	Sparkwright	Initiate

- **Optional Specializations:** Runebreaker (dismantles artifacts), Glassforge (delicate materials & alchemical components), Chainwright (armor, golems, and animated

constructs)

PART THIRTEEN: WEAVEKEEPER TOOLS

Setting Difficulty

When determining DCs, ask yourself: what level of competence would a character need to reliably succeed?

DC	Who Can Reliably Do This
8	Anyone with a bit of focus
11	A trained civilian mage on a good day
14	A guild journeyman's bread and butter
17	What senior specialists are specifically trained for
20	The outer edge of what a skilled person can reliably achieve
23+	Legendary. The best in the world might still fail.

Hollowing Corruption Rules

Characters who spend time near the Hollowing, are struck by high-HA attacks, or enter the Hollowing itself accumulate Corruption Points (maximum 10).

Corruption	Effect
1–2	Faint unease; Thread Sense distorted (–1 to THS checks)
3–4	Nightmares; –1 to THS checks; Shades find you more easily
5–6	Corrupted condition: Discord on Thread Checks; leylines feel wrong
7–8	Significant contamination: –2 to all attribute checks; risk of taint spreading to equipment
9	Critical corruption: all Thread Checks at Discord; begin losing specific memories (1 per day)
10	Full Corruption: danger of becoming a Hollowed Stalker. Requires immediate divine or legendary magical intervention.

Removing Corruption: Solar Temple healing removes 1d4 Corruption per session. Legendary healer or divine intervention can cleanse more rapidly.

Social Challenge Framework

Complex social situations are handled as Challenge Sequences — a series of checks where the goal is accumulating a target number of successes before hitting a failure limit.

Challenge Type	Target Successes	Failure Limit	When to Use
Standard	3	3	Most social encounters; convincing a guard, negotiating a price
High-Stakes	5	2	Convincing a guild leader, negotiating a treaty, royal audiences

Characters use whatever skills make sense for their approach. Multiple characters contributing from different angles (one building rapport, one providing lore backup, one reading the target's emotional state) can all contribute successes. Failures don't end the scene — they add complications.

Leyline Environment Effects

Location	Effect on Magic
Standard terrain	Normal rules
Leyline Nexus	All Thread Checks at Harmony, but all Snapback results move up one row on the table
Dead Zone	All Thread Checks at Discord; Power Level maximum -2
Contamination Zone	Discord on Thread Checks; all Snapback damage is also Corrupting (HA equal to Burnout level)
Hollowing Adjacent	Discord on all Thread Checks; Internal Magic unavailable; non-shadow affinities cost +2 Tension
Shattersea Coast	All Thread Checks at Discord; cannot maintain Anchors for more than 1 round; nightmares after rest
Storm conditions	Lightning/Air leylines at Harmony; Fire leylines at Discord; all ranged magical effects have Discord on targeting

APPENDIX A: CHARACTER SHEET OVERVIEW

Track the following on your character sheet:

- **Identity:** Name, Background, Affinity, Primary Mode, Secondary Mode (if unlocked), Tertiary Mode (if unlocked), Guild Affiliation, Guild Rank, Level
- **Attributes:** All six attributes (POT, CTR, RES, ACU, PRE, THS) with both Score and Modifier listed. Your Refinement Bonus (RB).
- **Derived Stats:** Current/Maximum VP, Thread Pool total, Safe Limit, Ward Rating, Guard Rating, Recovery Dice (current/total)
- **Tracking:** Burnout Track (circles 1–6), Fatigue Track (circles 1–6), Current Accumulated Tension (use tokens or a counter)
- **Skills:** All 18 skills listed with linked attribute. Attuned skills are checked.
- **Strings:** List your known Strings (developed with your Weavekeeper). Mark new ones as they unlock.
- **Techniques:** All Mode Techniques you know. Note which Mode they belong to.
- **Equipment:** Weapons, armor, gloves, talismans, tools. Note if gloves are worn — they reduce Snapback damage by 1d4 but impose Discord on Thread Sense checks.
- **Signature:** Written description of your visual and auditory signature. Reference it when you cast.
- **Wounds & Notes:** Active Wounds, Conditions, Corruption Points, and any Permanent Injuries.

APPENDIX B: QUICK REFERENCE

RULE

THE CORE LOOP: Roll d20 + Attribute Modifier. Beat the DC. Harmony = 2d20 take high. Discord = 2d20 take low.

Thread Check (Casting)

- Declare effect and Power Level
- Declare which Strings you're using (more Strings = more power, more risk)
- Roll d20 + CTR modifier (+RB if Attuned to relevant skill)
- Beat Power Level DC (8 / 11 / 14 / 17 / 20 for PL 1–5)
- On success: effect occurs, add Tension Cost to current Tension
- On fail: roll d6 on Mishap Table
- On natural 1: roll d12 on Snapback Table

Power Level Quick Reference

PL	Name	Tension Cost	DC	Scale
1	Flicker	1	8	Trivial (candle, small push)
2	Touch	3	11	Room-scale (heat, hold, shield)
3	Surge	6	14	Significant (throw person, real damage)
4	Fierce	10	17	Major (collapse wall, crowd effect)
5	Breaking	15	20	Catastrophic (siege-scale, miles-wide)

Tension Quick Reference

Situation	Rule
Tension > Safe Limit	Strain Check each turn: d20 + RES vs DC 10 + overage amount
Tension > Thread Pool	Automatic Snapback
Release Tension	Minor Action: reduce by up to Safe Limit; visible Signature burst
Mend (10 min)	Reset Tension to 0; recover VP; clear Shaking Hands, Burned

Leveling Up Quick Reference

Every Level	Specific Levels
+2 max VP	Level 4: Secondary Mode
+1 to one Attribute Score	Level 7: Tertiary Mode
Thread Pool & Safe Limit grow automatically	Levels 3, 5, 7, 9: New String
	Levels 2, 4, 6, 8, 10: New Technique
	Levels 3, 5, 7, 9: Refinement Bonus increases

Difficulty Classes

DC	Difficulty
8	Trivial
11	Easy
14	Moderate
17	Hard
20	Very Hard
23	Extreme
26+	Near-Impossible